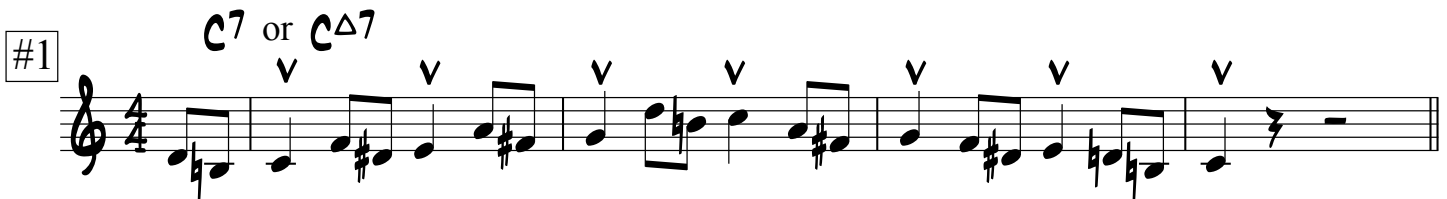


ENCLOSURES #3 - ABOVE & BELOW

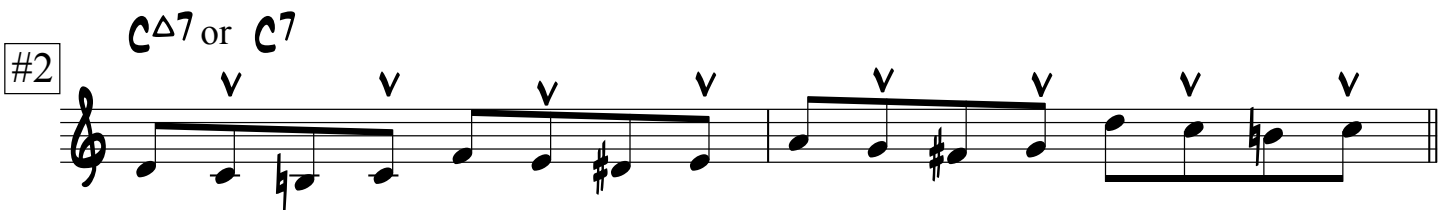
FROM DIGGING DEEPER VIDEO # 38

An Enclosure is a series of notes that "encloses" a target note. In example #1, below, a C triad are the target notes (C, E, G). This particular Enclosure is a very popular bebop lick, and could be described as "diatonic note above, half step below, then target note." The "vee" notations above some of the notes are just showing us the target notes, in this case the three pitches of a C major triad.

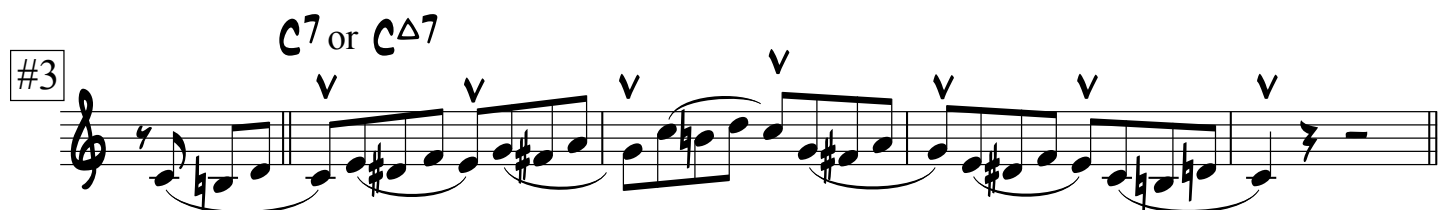


Lick #2, below, is basically the same lick as #1 in a slightly different rhythmic form. The whole idea behind Enclosures (also called Rotations, Chromatic Neighbors and a million other things) is to create tension. The tension we create with Enclosures is "functional" tension, in that it resolves properly. The tension in this Enclosure comes from the leading tones (B resolving up to C, D# resolving up to E, F# resolving up to G).

Since these Enclosures are targeting only the triad notes, they are very "usable" licks. This one can be used over major chords or dominant chords - anything with a major 3rd.



Lick #3, below, is yet another Enclosure lick, this time beginning with a longer "pick up" of three 8th notes. It still uses the "diatonic note above, half step below" formula, but this time actually begins on the target note (in this case, the target notes are C, E, G).



ENCLOSURES IN MINOR

And YES, we can have Minor Enclosures too (I knew you were going to ask). We can stay with the "diatonic above, half step below" formula. The only questions might be "which diatonic note above will we use?" Here are two examples of that question.



Here we used the Ab (the b6), coming from the Harmonic minor sound.



Here we used the A natural (the natural 6), coming from the Melodic or Dorian minor sound.

It's really just a matter of taste and of tonality, which one to use. Personally, I tend to use the Harmonic minor sound (with the Ab) more, in that it sounds "more minor" to me. Essentially, think of these melodic options just like how you would consider spices when you are cooking. You have two options in front of you - one is salt, and the other is sugar. Which do you want? Which taste is your palate hungry for? What works best in this setting?

Finally, here is an example of lick #2 (from the Major page), translated into minor. As you can see, there are only two pitches that are different (the Eb and the Ab) from the major version on page 1. The good news here is that the "formula" of the lick/melodic device stays the same. "Diatonic above, and half step below."

